

# BizzNEST Senior Associate Technical Assessment

## Personal Link Page with List and Bento Grid Modes

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Role: Aspiring developer at BizzNEST

Project Type: Linktree-style personal landing page

Tech Stack: Vite, React, and plain CSS

### TL;DR

I built a responsive Linktree-style personal landing page for my portfolio, resume, LinkedIn, and GitHub. The baseline page gives visitors a simple way to access my most important links, while the custom feature lets them switch between a classic list view and a more visual bento grid view.

My goal was to make the page feel more personal than a basic link page without making it confusing. I wanted it to stay easy to use, but also show more of my interest in UI design, visual systems, and interaction details.

### Project Goal

The goal of this project was to build a polished personal link page that works well on desktop and mobile. It needed to include a profile area, real links, clear hover and focus states, responsive styling, and clean React components that I can explain in an interview.

I also wanted the project to feel like something I would actually use. Instead of making the page look like a default template, I focused on strong typography, simple layout decisions, color, spacing, and small interactions that make the page feel intentional.

## Problem

Most link-in-bio pages are useful, but they can feel repetitive. A vertical list is quick and familiar, but every link usually has the same visual weight. That makes the page easy to scan, but it can also make it easy to ignore.

For a personal portfolio, I wanted the page to do a little more. I wanted visitors to understand my links quickly, but I also wanted the page to show my design taste and give the project a stronger first impression.

## Insight

The main thing I wanted to improve was attention. A list gives people access, but a visual layout can create more interest. If the page can show hierarchy, color, and card sizing, each link can communicate more than just a title.

That led me to the idea of giving users two ways to browse the same content. Some people may want the fast list version. Others may enjoy the more visual grid version. Both views should feel connected, simple, and easy to use.

## Custom Feature

The custom feature is a List / Grid View Toggle.

In List View, the page works like a traditional Linktree page. The links are stacked vertically, easy to tap, and quick to scan.

In Grid View, the same links turn into a bento-style layout. The portfolio card becomes the featured card, while the other links use smaller cards with bold colors and visual hierarchy.

This feature improves the experience because it gives the page two different modes without changing the actual content. The user can stay in the simple version or switch into a more expressive layout.

The bento layout is also meant to be a better alternative when someone has more than just a few links. Instead of showing visitors an extremely long column where every link feels the same, the grid can help

organize links by importance. In the future, I would want users to customize card sizes so the most important links can be bigger and easier to notice.

I also see the grid view as a place where link previews could become useful. A card could include an image, screenshot, or visual preview, which would help visitors understand where they are going before they click.

## Design Decisions

I used bold typography because I wanted the page to feel confident and graphic. The large name treatment gives the page more personality and makes it feel closer to a portfolio landing page than a standard utility page.

I used bright link colors so each card has its own identity. The colors also help the grid view feel more visual and easier to scan.

I kept the controls minimal. The layout toggle and theme toggle sit in the top corner so they are available, but they do not distract from the main links.

I added light and dark mode because the page uses strong contrast and color. The theme switch also gave me a chance to practice interaction polish, including the animated theme reveal.

## Implementation

The project is built with Vite, React, and plain CSS. I avoided Tailwind, shadcn, and component libraries so the code stays simple and easy for me to explain.

The page is split into small components: ProfileHeader, LinkList, LinkCard, LinkGrid, and LayoutToggle. The link content lives in `src/data/links.js`, so URLs, descriptions, colors, and icons can be updated from one place.

The list and grid views use the same link data. This keeps the project easier to maintain because I am not duplicating content for each layout.

The resume link points to a PDF in the public folder, so visitors can open or download my resume directly from the page.

## Responsive Design

I spent a lot of time adjusting the layout for mobile because the bento grid needed to feel intentional on small screens too. On mobile, the grid becomes a stacked layout with the portfolio card first, LinkedIn and resume side by side, and GitHub underneath.

I also checked that the page does not create horizontal scrolling on mobile. This was important because a few pixels of overflow can make the site feel unstable on a phone.

## Testing and Final Checks

I tested the production build with `npm run build`.

I checked the deployed GitHub Pages version, not just localhost, to make sure the live site was using the newest files.

I verified that the profile image loads, the main links work, the resume PDF opens, the list/grid toggle works, the dark/light mode works, and the mobile layout does not horizontally scroll.

## What I Learned

This project reminded me how much small layout details matter. A few pixels can change whether something feels intentional or slightly off.

I also learned that a custom feature does not have to be complicated to be useful. The List / Grid toggle is simple, but it changes the personality of the page and gives users a different way to experience the same content.

## If I Continued

If I had more time, I would build the bento grid into a more customizable feature. The user could choose which links should be larger, smaller, or more emphasized depending on what they want visitors to click first.

I would also add the option to attach preview images to links. For example, a portfolio link could show a project preview, while a resume or GitHub link could stay simpler. I think this would make the page more useful for people who have a lot of links, because visitors would not have to scroll through an extremely long list where everything feels equally important.

## Submission Links

**Live Site:** [jasontello.github.io/bizznest-linktree-assessment](https://jasontello.github.io/bizznest-linktree-assessment)

**GitHub Repository:** [github.com/jasontello/bizznest-linktree-assessment](https://github.com/jasontello/bizznest-linktree-assessment)

**Portfolio:** [jasontello.com](https://jasontello.com)